

Chapter 27 — Biconsonantal / Geminate Disambiguation Drill

BBH Chapters 25 & 27 · Niphal and Hiphil Weak Verbs

For each form: (1) identify the stem (Niphal or Hiphil); (2) parse — conjugation, PGN; (3) identify the weak class (Biconsonantal or Geminate); (4) give the root and translate. Biconsonantal and Geminate forms are vocally identical — root knowledge is required. Answer key is on the last page.

Biconsonantal (II-ו/ה): medial vowel letter ו or י retained in stem (e.g. וּכְנַח, שָׁמַח, בָּרַח, בָּרַח, בָּרַח). Geminate (R2=R3): same consonant at R2 and R3; no medial vowel letter (e.g. סָבַב, מָמַח). Both classes share: Niphal perfect נָ, (qamets); Hiphil perfect הָ, (tsere); Hiphil imperfect יָ, (qamets); Hiphil imperative הָ, (qamets); Hiphil participle מְ, (tsere).

Part A — Niphal: Biconsonantal vs. Geminate

All forms are Niphal. Identify whether each is Biconsonantal (medial ו/ה) or Geminate (R2=R3). The prefix vowel pattern (נָ, in perfect; יָ, in imperfect) is identical for both classes.

#	Form	Ref	Context	Stem	Conjugation	PGN	Class	Root
1	וּכְנַח	Gen 41:32	"the thing is ___ by God"					
2	וּסְבַב	1 Kgs 7:24	"the gourds ___ it, ten to a					
3	יִכְנַח	Psa 93:2	"your throne ___ from of old"					
4	יִסְבּוּ	Num 21:4	"they traveled ___ Mount Edom"					
5	יִכְנֹחַ	Psa 57:8	"my heart is ___, O God"					
6	יִסְבּוּ	Num 34:4	"your border ___ from the					
7	נִשְׁבַּח	Lam 3:40	"let us examine and ___ to the					
8	נִתְּחַם	1 Sam 3:12	"when I ___ what I have					

Part B — Hiphil: Biconsonantal vs. Geminate

All forms are Hiphil. Hiphil prefix patterns: הָ, (perfect) · יָ, (imperfect) · הָ, (imperative) · מְ, (participle). These are identical for Biconsonantal and Geminate — root knowledge is the only distinguisher.

#	Form	Ref	Context	Stem	Conjugation	PGN	Class	Root
9	הִקְיִם	Gen 6:18	"I will ___ my covenant with					
10	הִסְבִּיחַ	2 Sam 2:22	"___ from following me"					
11	יִקְיִם	Deut 18:15	"the LORD will ___ a prophet"					
12	יִסְבֵּחַ	Eccl 1:6	"the wind ___ to the south"					
13	הִקְדִּים	Deut 27:26	"___ the words of this law"					
14	הִסְבִּיחַ	2 Sam 2:22	"___ from following me"					
15	מִקְיִם	1 Sam 2:8	"He ___ the poor from the dust"					
16	מִסְבֵּחַ	Jer 21:4	"I am turning around the					

Part C — Mixed: Stem and Class Both Unknown

Identify both the stem (Niphal/Hiphal/Qal/Hophal) and the class. Part C includes Qal and Hophal forms as distractors — not every Biconsonantal form is Niphal or Hiphil.

#	Form	Ref	Context	Stem	Conjugation	PGN	Class	Root
17	נָמוּג	Isa 14:31	"all Philistia ____"					
18	הִמָּטוּ	Deu 1:28	"our brothers ____ our hearts"					
19	יָרָם	Isa 52:13	"my servant shall be high and					
20	יָרָם	Psa 99:2	"great is the LORD, ____ above					
21	הִרָּיִם	Gen 14:22	"I have ____ my hand to the					
22	הוֹרָם	Lev 4:10	"just as it is ____ from the peace					
23	יָשׁוּב	Hos 14:8	"they ____ in the shade"					
24	יִשָּׁב	Lam 1:11	"all her people ____ to find					

Reflection Questions

- Items 1 (נָמוּג) and 2 (הִמָּטוּ) have the same נ. prefix. What is the only reliable way to identify נָמוּג as Biconsonantal (root נ.מ.ג) and הִמָּטוּ as Geminate (root ט.מ.ט)?
- Items 9 (מִיָּקָה) and 10 (מִיָּסָה) both have ה. prefix (tsere). One retains a medial vowel letter; the other shows a contracted stem. Describe precisely what the medial position of each form looks like and how that reflects the root structure.
- Items 11 (מִיָּקָה) and 12 (מִיָּסָה) are both Hiphil imperfect 3ms. You encounter an unknown form יִדָּל. What question must you ask to determine if it is Biconsonantal or Geminate?
- Items 19 (יָרָם) and 21 (הִרָּיִם) come from the same root (מ.ר.) but differ in stem. What vowel under R2 distinguishes the Niphal imperfect from the Hiphil perfect?
- Item 22 (הוֹרָם) was classified as Hophal. How does the Hophal Biconsonantal prefix (וה.) differ from Niphal (נ.) and Hiphil (ה.), and what does it tell you about the semantics?

Answer Key

#	Form	Stem	Answer
1	נָכֵן	Niphal	Perfect/Ptc · 3ms/ms · Biconsonantal · נִּכְּ — "is established / firm" — נִּ, prefix (qamets); medial ו vowel
2	נָסַב	Niphal	Perfect · 3ms · Geminate · נִּבְּסַ — "encircled / went around" — נִּ, prefix (qamets); R2=R3=ב = Geminate;
3	יִכְּנֶה	Niphal	Imperfect · 3ms · Biconsonantal · יִכְּנֶה — "is established" — יִ, + dagesh in כּ + holem-vav = Niphal
4	יִסְבֵּה	Niphal	Imperfect · 3ms · Geminate · יִסְבֵּה — "went around" — יִ, + dagesh in ס (R2=R3 doubled) + holem =
5	הִכְּנֶה	Niphal	Perfect · 3ms · Biconsonantal · הִכְּנֶה — "is ready / prepared" — הִ, + dagesh + holem-vav = Niphal
6	הִסְבֵּה	Niphal	Perfect · 3ms · Geminate · הִסְבֵּה — "turned / went around" — הִ, + dagesh in ס (R2=R3) + holem = Niphal
7	נָשׁוּב	Niphal	Cohortative · 1cp · Biconsonantal · נָשׁוּב — "let us return" — נִ, prefix + medial ו = Niphal Biconsonantal;
8	נִתְּמָה	Niphal	Inf. Const. · — · Geminate · נִתְּמָה — "to be completed / finished" — נִ, prefix + holem = Niphal Geminate
9	הִקְיֵם	Hiphil	Perfect · 3ms · Biconsonantal · הִקְיֵם — "established / raised up" — הִ, prefix (tsere) = Hiphil; medial ו vowel
10	הִסְבִּה	Hiphil	Perfect · 3ms · Geminate · הִסְבִּה — "turned aside" — הִ, prefix (tsere) = Hiphil; no medial vowel letter,
11	יִקְיֵם	Hiphil	Imperfect · 3ms · Biconsonantal · יִקְיֵם — "will raise up" — יִ, prefix (qamets) = Hiphil Biconsonantal
12	יִסְבִּה	Hiphil	Imperfect · 3ms · Geminate · יִסְבִּה — "causes to go around / turns" — יִ, prefix (qamets) = Hiphil; no
13	הִקְיֵם	Hiphil	Imperative · 2ms · Biconsonantal · הִקְיֵם — "raise up! / confirm!" — הִ, prefix (qamets) = Hiphil imperative;
14	הִסְבִּה	Hiphil	Imperative · 2ms · Geminate · הִסְבִּה — "turn aside!" — הִ, prefix (qamets) = Hiphil imperative; same vowels
15	מִקְיֵם	Hiphil	Participle · ms · Biconsonantal · מִקְיֵם — "one who raises up" — מִ, prefix (tsere) = Hiphil participle; medial ו
16	מִסְבִּה	Hiphil	Participle · ms · Geminate · מִסְבִּה — "turning / surrounding" — מִ, prefix (tsere) = Hiphil participle; no
17	נִמְּוָה	Niphal	Perfect · 3ms · Biconsonantal · נִמְּוָה — "melted / dissolved" — נִ, prefix + medial ו = Niphal Biconsonantal;
18	הִמְסִי	Hiphil	Perfect · 3cp · Geminate · הִמְסִי — "caused to melt" — הִ, prefix (tsere) = Hiphil; R2=R3=ס = Geminate;
19	יִרְם	Niphal	Imperfect · 3ms · Biconsonantal · יִרְם — "will be exalted / lifted up" — יִ, prefix + qibbutz under R2
20	יִרְם	Niphal	Imperfect · 3ms · Biconsonantal · יִרְם — "is exalted / high" — יִ, prefix + holem under R2 = Niphal
21	הִרְיֵם	Hiphil	Perfect · 3ms · Biconsonantal · הִרְיֵם — "lifted up / swore an oath" — הִ, prefix (tsere) + chiriq-yod = Hiphil
22	הוֹרֵם	Hophal	Perfect · 3ms · Biconsonantal · הוֹרֵם — "was lifted off / removed" — הוֹ, prefix (holem-vav) = Hophal
23	יִשׁוּב	Qal	Imperfect · 3ms · Biconsonantal · יִשׁוּב — "will dwell / return" — Qal Biconsonantal — no Niphal נ or Hiphil
24	יִשְׁבֵּה	Qal	Imperfect · 3ms · Biconsonantal · יִשְׁבֵּה — "returned / went around" — Qal Biconsonantal; holem vowel